

QUESTION: WHOSE FOLLY IS LEAST?

BENTON COUNTY PAPER BELIEVES ROADMASTER'S SIN EQUALS THAT OF BRIBER

SUGGESTS JAIL FOR BRIBER

Courier Hopes World is Honest But Has Its Doubts After Hearing of Deal

(From the Benton County Courier)

The Courier has received facts and full information about a little matter that makes the editor ask that world-old question "What's the use?"

The Courier has been trying to play a straight game, and has been fighting for the best that it could get for the good people. It has believed that there was a certain amount of honesty in this world, and that some public officials were honest men.

Maybe there are—the Courier will continue to hope so—but it is harder work doing the hoping now.

The facts that have come to the Courier do not concern Benton county. But the editor thinks they are worth printing anyway, as a warning and example. And because the story doesn't concern Benton county people, we're not naming names—there's no use in advertising crooks unless it will do some good. However, maybe the thing will interest Benton county officials and Benton county common people—so the Courier is going to tell about it anyway. Here goes:

Down at the hotel Benson in Portland some time ago they had some sort of a "good roads" meeting. There were a lot of county judges, county commissioners, county road engineers and county roadmasters there, as well as some supply men and the patented paving bunch. Among those present was Mister Sarpent, the well known dealer in road machinery, post holes and ditches.

After the meeting was over, Mr. Sarpent went around shaking hands with the people he knew. Among those he gripped with the grip of friendship was Roadmaster Crookes. He wrung Roadmaster Crookes' hand and then moved on.

After the hand shaking Roadmaster Crookes felt something in his hand. Slipping into a dark corner of the Benson he investigated, and found that Mister Sarpent had slipped him a ball of green paper. Opening the ball, he discovered it was a hundred-dollar bill. Roadmaster Crookes smiled, put the hundred-dollar bill in his jeans, and wandered around for half an hour.

Then he met County Judge Henderson, head of the county court that gave him his pay. He drew the judge aside and showed him the hundred-dollar bill. He told him to keep the money till the next day and then to bring it to his office.

Next day, back in the county seat, Roadmaster Crookes wandered into Judge Henderson's office with the hundred dollar bill. District Attorney Jones was there, too. Roadmaster Crookes told all about the deal, and the judge and the district attorney listened to him. Then they took the hundred dollar bill, put it in an envelope, wrote some remarks for identification on the outside of it, and put the envelope and the bill in the county treasurer's vault.

Time passed, and one day Mr. Sarpent, the dealer in road machinery, post holes and ditches, met Roadmaster Crookes. After they'd shaken hands and talked about the weather, Mr. Sarpent said he supposed Roadmaster Crookes would be ordering some postholes pretty soon.

"Not necessarily," said the roadmaster. "And if we do order any, we'll buy them from the firm that offers us the lowest price."

Mr. Sarpent was surprised. He admitted it. One thing led to another and finally Roadmaster Crookes told Mr. Sarpent what he had done with that hundred-dollar bill.

"And what's more, Mr. Sarpent," he added, "you are going to sell us any road machinery, post holes or ditches that we need this year at fifteen per cent less than the lowest list price, and you're also going to rebate us five per cent on what you sold us last year."

And the next day Mr. Sarpent sent County Judge Henderson a check for about \$130 as "five per cent allowed discount on last year's contract."

That's all the story. Probably Roadmaster Crookes, Judge Henderson and District Attorney Jones thought they had put over something pretty slick on Mr. Sarpent. They'd found a way to "save the taxpayers' money." And they'll probably save the taxpayers in the neighborhood of \$300 for two years that the transaction will cover. And all because Roadmaster Crookes kept that funny-looking ball of paper in his hand until Mr. Sarpent got plenty far enough away from him.

Well, maybe this is all right. But right here the Courier editor wants to say that he'd rather be Mr. Sarpent, who behaved according to the ethics of modern business, than he

NORTHERN DISTRICTS WOULD CONSOLIDATE

WANT WATER SERVICE, BUT DON'T CARE TO BE TIED TO OREGON CITY

A movement to incorporate all territory between Jennings Lodge and Oregon City and south of Oregon City, putting it within the limits of the county seat, will be thoroughly counteracted if plans being outlined in the northern part of this area carry. The idea now is to take advantage of recent legislation permitting territories to incorporate, including municipalities, for the purpose of obtaining water service. This was the reason for the suggestion to extend the limits of Oregon City.

It is now proposed to consolidate all that part of the county south of Milwaukie to the Clackamas river and east of the Willamette river to the Otfield road for the purpose of obtaining water service from the Portland system. The plan has gained such headway in the last few days that its sponsors, in the communities affected, believe there is no doubt of its success.

In the meantime, there are being prepared in this city plans for extending the corporate limits to take in territory as far north as Jennings Lodge and as far south as Canemah. The proposition will be submitted to the voters at an early date, with figures as to the cost. Such a plan would increase Oregon City's valuation practically 100 per cent and would reduce the municipal tax by two-thirds.

The latter plan to consolidate the territory outside Oregon City for water service alone is said to have the united support of the districts involved, because of the fact that they can, at the same time, retain their separate identities.

SCHOOLS OF COUNTY ACTIVELY AT WORK

INDUSTRIAL CAMPAIGN ON THIS WEEK. LEAGUE WORK WELL UNDER WAY

Following up the work done in this county in interesting school children in industrial club work, Superintendent J. E. Calavan of Clackamas county and N. C. Morris, field worker for the state department of education, have been active with an enthusiastic campaign this week.

On Monday the workers held a meeting and gave talks at Damascus, Rock Creek and Union, giving a stereotypical lecture at Damascus. They spoke chiefly upon industrial club work and the possibilities it holds out for school children and the pictures they put on the screen were evidence of the accomplishments of industrial club members in other counties of the state and in other states.

Tuesday the superintendent and Mr. Morris were at Batten and Oak Grove and will return to Oak Grove tomorrow night for an illustrated lecture. They gave a stereotypical lecture at Batten on Tuesday evening. Yesterday meetings were held at Fir Grove, Redland and Evergreen and in each case a great deal of interest was aroused in the club plans. In schools where industrial clubs are already at work the interest is said to have been keen, and the prospects for considerable development in club work in the county are bright, Mr. Calavan stated.

A stereotypical lecture will be given at Canemah this evening and during the day meetings will be held at Canby and Barlow. The week's campaign will close tomorrow with a series of meetings at Clairmont, Maple Lane, Henri, Carus, Mount Pleasant and Twilight school houses, and the illustrated lecture at Oak Grove in the evening.

Several of the club projects under way in the schools which have organized clubs are nearly completed and the work shows the real benefit of the campaign that was conducted last spring and fall. The work exhibited by the children at the recent parents' day programs throughout the county was largely the production of club workers. Between now and the end of the school year practically all the clubs in the county schools will have completed their projects.

Under Supervisor Brenton Vedder the school league work in the county is assuming interesting proportions. Mr. Vedder is busy just now arranging a baseball schedule for the several school teams which have joined the county school league and work on the diamond will be the order for the spare hours during the spring months.

According to Mr. Vedder, more and better work is being done since the organization of the school leagues than was ever produced in this county before. In short story writing and essay work especially is this true, Mr. Vedder says. In this branch of endeavor the results of the work are in and are ready for the judges to select the winners in the prize contests.

Tomorrow evening the first of the series of debates between the ten grammar school teams in the debate

VOTES APPROVAL OF BONDING BILL

CAMPAIGN COMMITTEE NAMED BY COMMERCIAL CLUB PRES. IDENT O. D. EBY

SPEAKERS ARE PROMINENT

Simon Benson Says Little Fellows Trying to Defeat the Good Roads Plans

The Oregon City Commercial club went on record Monday night by a large majority as favoring the \$6,000,000 road bond issue upon which the voters will ballot on June 4. A large number of prominent citizens of the state were present at the meeting to discuss the bond proposal and much valuable information as to the plans of the bond sponsors was made known.

The vote upon the bond issue came after an enthusiastic debate of the measure and registered the club as 23 to 4 favorable to the measure. Such prominent men as Simon Benson of Portland, Bruce Dennis of La Grande, and John C. Coffey and Jay Bowerman of Portland and B. T. McBain of Oregon City were among those who supported the bond issue in the lively debate that was held.

On the other side of the fence were C. E. Spence, state grange master, J. D. Brown, president of the Farmers' union and William Lillie of Park place. These gentlemen argued strongly against the measure and after the vote of approval was taken V. F. Cooper of Oswego joined with them in a denunciation of the bonding proposition. Senator Walter A. Dimick argued upon the bill with club members.

President O. D. Eby, following instructions from the meeting, appointed the following committee to have charge of the campaign for the bond issue in this county: Dr. L. A. Morris, M. D. Latourette, J. F. Riley, Dr. Hugh S. Mount, Livy Stipp, B. T. McBain, A. C. Warner, H. G. Starkweather, Judge G. B. Dimick, Wallace Caulfield, W. H. Bair and A. King Wilson.

Jay Bowerman, author of the road bonds bill, explained his reasons for preparing it by saying that, throughout the session the legislature had made no provision for road business, and something had to be done. Simon Benson charged the little fellows with attempting to defeat the bond measure. He advised going in to debt for road building and pointed out that the bonding plan improved the main state roads with state money while county funds were left for the construction of lateral roads.

On the other side of the question Master C. E. Spence, of the state grange, asserted that the railroad had retarded the development of Oregon by failure to build feeder lines, and that the proposed bond issue would not nearly cover the road program outlined.

"The legislature was bulldozed into passing this measure, and its result will be that Oregon will spend the \$6,000,000 and find it has to bond again for double the amount to complete its plans," Mr. Spence said.

J. D. Brown, president of the Farmers' union, said: "The bond measure maps the state highways to pass through the doorways of every man in the legislature whose vote was needed, and the entire bill is drawn to favor the paving contractors."

WAGES INCREASED

The Hawley Pulp & Paper Co. last week boosted prosperity in Oregon City when it announced an increase in salary of 35 of its employees.

The raise was from \$2.25 a day to \$2.40 for 10 hours' work, and the result is that \$2.40 is practically the minimum wage at the Hawley mills. Within another month the new Main street addition will be ready for full operation and the force will be materially added to.

Girls Will Serve Tea

The Girls' Honor Guard has been granted the free use of Huntley Bros' green room for a tea which is planned for Saturday afternoon to raise funds to carry on the work of the organization. The guard members will serve tea throughout the afternoon and will make the occasion more pleasant with a musical program arranged among the members. During the afternoon the young women will be actively at the work of recruiting, but are to give major attention to the entertainment of their friends.

division of the league will be held. Each school in the league is to be represented by an affirmative and a negative team. The three high schools entered in the high school debate league will hold their first contest on March 30. The high schools represented are Canby, Colton and Milwaukie.

WIRES ARE TO FEAST AT MOUNT PLEASANT

MEETING APPROVES BOND BILL AND HEARS LIVELY TALKS ON MEASURE

The proposed \$6,000,000 bonding issue for good roads furnished food for thought and oratory at the Live Wire luncheon at the Commercial club here on Tuesday and threatened to become a highly vexatious topic before it was finally approved by an unanimous vote of the Wires in the presence of a number of prominent men ardently against the measure.

Whether to debate the bond issue at meetings which may be held in rural communities was another question that brought out much talk at the meeting. The matter was settled for the time being when the members decided to stage a strictly Live Wire debate upon the question at the next meeting and let future sessions take care of themselves.

An invitation from Mount Pleasant folk was accepted by the Wires and the members will hold their regular meeting there next Tuesday evening. The invitation was given with the understanding, it is said, that the bond issue would be discussed and in order to satisfy the desires of the hosts the debate between teams of Live Wires was arranged. Members will take both sides of the question in the discussion.

The Wires Tuesday voted to support the Commercial club's committee of 12 in its campaign for the bond issue in this county and the Wires will assist in taking the doctrine of good roads, via bond issues, to all sections of the county before June 4, the date of the special election called to decide the matter of the bonds. Other than the informal discussions at its meetings about the county and at home the Wires themselves will take no active part in the election campaign.

At the meeting Tuesday, M. J. Ross, a pioneer paper manufacturer and friend of W. P. Hawley, Sr., whose guest he was at the luncheon, was a speaker. Mr. Ross told of the road business as it is being conducted in Wisconsin, his home state, and commended bonding measures generally to the support of the club. The first cost, Mr. Ross emphasized, is great, but at the end of 25 years hard surfaced roads will be found to have cost far less than the present road types. He also discussed in an interesting manner the educational results that accrue from good roads. The community school and the district school are made immensely more of an asset when the country they serve is served by good roads. Better teaching staffs are possible and larger schools are being built to draw pupils from a larger radius than the old schools could.

The educational facilities are improved by good roads through the centralization of schools. Mr. Ross said, since the larger the school the better its equipment must be. Transportation to and from schools of this kind is by buses supported by the school patrons.

Speakers at meeting brought out strongly the point that good main trunk roads must be built before lateral roads could be of any service. The 27 miles of roadway proposed for hard surfacing through Clackamas county, it was pointed out, pass the doorways of practically 27 miles of farms, so that the farmers have no object in complaining that the bond issue is only proposed to improve scenic highways. The trunk roads are essential, and the improvement of the laterals will undoubtedly follow, it was stated. The farmer who lives off the main road, according to one speaker, now travels 14 miles to get to town and every mile of the distance is over poor roads. If the main highway is improved it will cut down the poor road distance five miles, for instance, and will thus be of untold value to the farmer not living right on the road to be improved.

A letter from the White House, signed by Secretary Tumulty, was read by Sub-Trunk W. P. Hawley, Jr., who presided at the meeting. It expressed the sincere appreciation of his actions expressed in resolutions recently passed by the Live Wires.

The club will assemble at the Commercial club next Tuesday evening for the trip to Mount Pleasant, where they will be fed by the grangers. Automobiles will be provided for their transportation and the bond issue debate for their entertainment.

Anna Fauske Appointed

The county court appointed Anna C. Fauske administratrix of the estate of Hans Fauske, who died in this county on January 1, last. The administratrix is a sister and one of 14 heirs to the estate comprising real property valued at \$5000.

Mr. Skene, Jr., Comes

A nine-pound son was born to the wife of D. F. Skene, of this city, on Sunday morning. This is the first boy in the Skene home and is more than sharing honors with the daughters in the family.

James Wants Board Bill

L. N. Jones filed suit Saturday against Henry Barth, asking \$1085 on a bill for the board, care and medical attention given Mrs. Barth and her children.

BRIDGES SEATED VACANCY FILLED

RECALL THREAT SPURS COUNCIL TO DEFINITE ACTION FINE IS REMITTED

MANY OBJECTIONS ENTERED

Aldermen Will Investigate Claims of Damage by Sewer. Bid Made on Lot.

A possible recall election against E. B. Andrews, former alderman, last night brought the city council to action and that body elected Isom C. Bridges to occupy Mr. Andrews' seat, to which he was elected by the people at the last election. Mr. Andrews contested Mr. Bridges' seat and took his fight into court, where Judge Campbell ousted Bridges because he had not satisfied the residence requirements. Bridges appealed the case and it is pending in the supreme court. In the meantime he circulated recall petitions against Andrews and last night presented them to the council with nearly 250 names of voters in the first ward. An opinion from City Prosecutor Story said Andrews had no right to claim the seat and upon motion of Councilman Van Aukon, Bridges was elected by the council to make his title to the seat legal.

To fill the vacancy caused by the expulsion of John F. Albright of the first ward, the council last night elected J. J. Tobin, Main street hotel man. Mr. Tobin was sworn in and will take Albright's place as chairman of the fire and water committee with Councilmen Buckles and Bridges.

The council chamber was crowded with taxpayers in sewer district No. 10, who filed scores of objections to the assessment to pay for the work on the sewer. Two petitions bearing 75 names of property owners adjoining Sixteenth street were among the objections. Several of those present claimed the sewer work had damaged their property and others said the assessment was out of all proportion to the value of their property. The council as a whole will constitute a board of viewers to inspect the work and investigate the claims of taxpayers on Saturday afternoon.

The sewer work being assessed at this time represents an expenditure on the part of the city of \$20,452. The total cost of the work was \$33,000. A bid of \$3000 was received last night with a certified check for \$300 as a guarantee of faith, on the Main street lot that was sold to W. P. Hawley to provide money for the purchase of a fire truck. Mr. Hawley bid \$1500 for the property and the bidder last night was the Northwestern Fire Apparatus Co., which demands consideration for its fire truck. The council considered the bid as coming too late and passed on final reading the ordinance selling the property to Mr. Hawley. The check was returned to the late bidder.

Upon motion of Councilman Roy B. Cox, the city recorder was instructed to return to Leslie Wells a fine of \$15, paid when that young man was arrested with J. F. Albright, then councilman, on a charge of intoxication. Mr. Albright escaped without a penalty and the same justice was demanded for Wells in view of the fact that he was a witness for the city at the Albright trial.

INVESTIGATE DANCES

Sheriff Has Nuisance Abated After Fight Among Guests

County officials are paying particular attention these days to dances in several sections of the county where threatened riots and fights have been reported. Recently a hall at Clackamas heights was raided after a fight had broken out among the guests and the result was that an order to abate a nuisance has been issued.

This week Sheriff Wilson and deputies have investigated several halls in different parts of the county, but have taken no action toward closing any of them except the one at Clackamas heights. Alcohol and hard cider is blamed by officials for conditions that have been reported several times, and they have ascertained that strangers are the chief transgressors in most cases.

To Organize Permanently

Permanent organization of the Commercial club's committee to advance the road bond campaign in this county will be effected at a meeting on Friday evening, according to the announcement Tuesday of O. D. Eby, president of the club. The committee is composed of 12 business and professional men and they will outline plans for their campaign at the meeting. Friday. The committee hopes to boost the \$6,000,000 road bond measure in all sections of the county and one of the first steps in the campaign will be to plan an itinerary of meetings for the next two months.

Recital is Good

The recital of Miss Mabel Volkmar's music pupils brought out a large number of friends and relatives on Saturday afternoon. The program was rendered by 17 musicians trained by Miss Volkmar. The youngest of these, Beverly Schoenborn, had to be lifted to the piano stool before she could reach the keys to play "Bye lo, Baby." Miss Morista Hickman rendered several vocal selections.

Next Meeting of Association in December. Committees Appointed

Portland has been selected as the place for the next annual meeting of the Oregon State Teachers' association. It will be held December 27 to 29, inclusive.

A decision to this effect was reached by the executive committee of the association at a meeting held at Salem Saturday afternoon. Important committees were also appointed. One committee is to report on plans for the standardization of school credits; another is to investigate the certification laws, and still another is to examine into the question of standardizing rural schools.

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CONGRESS ASKED TO DECLARE WAR STATE

EXTRAORDINARY SESSION WILL DEAL WITH GERMANS' WARLIKE MOVES

President Wilson, recognizing that Germany practically is making war on the United States on the seas, Wednesday called congress to assemble in extraordinary session on April 2 to deal with the situation.

The purpose of the session, now called two weeks earlier than the date first set, as announced in the president's proclamation, is to receive a communication from the chief executive concerning "grave matters of national policy which should be taken immediately under consideration."

The president in his address to congress will detail how Germany practically has been making war on the United States by the ruthless destruction of American lives and ships on the high seas in contravention of all the laws of nations and humanity.

Congress then is expected to pass a resolution declaring that a state of war has existed between the United States and Germany for some time. Such a resolution in itself will not be a declaration of war in a technical sense, although practically it will amount to the same thing.

As a consequence the United States will take further steps to protect its interests on the high seas and elsewhere against the warlike acts of Germany and whether an actual state of war will come to exist in its full sense will depend on the future acts of the imperial German government.

Since last Sunday, when three American ships were sunk off the British isles in quick succession with loss of American lives—bringing the total number of Americans lost through German submarine operations to more than 200—the president and all his advisers have recognized that a state of war existed. From all parts of the country have come calls for the immediate summoning of congress in extra session.

Although the president, by the provisions of the constitution, must leave it to congress to make the practical declaration of war, such advice as have come to the White house from members of congress, governors of states, public officials and many hundreds of citizens have contained statements of support of such a policy in its fullest sense.

The cabinet, which urged the move upon the president at Monday's session, is described by its members as having been more thoroughly united than it has been on any other question that has come before it.

The nation now actually comes to the point which all the history of centuries indicated must necessarily follow the severance of diplomatic relations with Germany February 3.

EASTER EDITION

For several years the Courier has made it a practice to issue just before Easter an edition carrying the spring announcements of the merchants of Oregon City.

On Thursday next the annual Easter edition will appear. It will be important from the fact that the year's gayest season will be ushered in with the attractive offerings of the local merchants—the fine wearables for the pretty spring days, the early summer garments that make Easter additionally attractive to the women folk and to the men.

A special effort will be made to present to the readers of the Courier the announcements of the progressive business men of the city, that class of merchants which is anxious enough for your trade to let you know what they have for the spring and summer season.

TEACHERS AT PORTLAND

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COURIER IS 35 AND VERY HAPPY

OUR BIRTHDAY ANNIVERSARY IS A QUIET HOMELIKE LITTLE AFFAIR

MAYOR EXTENDS GREETINGS

C. Weismandel Read First Courier Ever Printed. That Was Long Years Ago

How old do you feel at 35?

Today the Courier is quietly celebrating its 35th birthday anniversary and rejoices calmly in the knowledge that it is mature—that it has grown up. We feel old and very wise as we review the history of the Courier and the histories of the more recently established journals.

We are not chummy because we have a better paper than we had 35 years ago. We respect the memory of the Courier's founder, Isaac LeMahieu, as a man who put his best effort into the upbuilding of a newspaper and the result he achieved was notable in that day. He made an inauspicious start, but he had the courage of his convictions. He knew that a democratic newspaper in this republican county would be successful in spite of the calamity waiting brethren who surrounded him on all sides and haunted his dreams. He invested his money and his energy in the foundation upon which future owners have built until they have produced the Courier as you see it today.

Never once in its history has the Courier swerved from the pathway of righteousness as its owners have seen it. It has adhered steadfastly to the democratic faith and has had as its sole endeavor throughout these many years the publication of a clean, modern news organ for Clackamas county people.

What we have achieved thus far stands prominent in the minds of our older readers. We are proud, in a quiet way, about our successful life.

On our 35th birthday anniversary we are running more column inches of Clackamas county news matter each week than any other three newspapers in Clackamas county combined, and including the six issues of the daily paper.

We are running more inches of advertising than any weekly paper in the county; we are getting more for our space than any other paper in the county because advertisers generally realize the value of the Courier as a successful advertising medium.

We have a larger, more comprehensive circulation than any other newspaper in the county and cover a wider field than any other paper distributed in the county.

That is something to be proud of in these days of keen competition. We are proud of our new building when we look back at the little office room that saw the first Courier printed. We are proud of a dozen and one things in our long and successful history.

But the letters of congratulation we have received within the week give us more cause for genuine delight than any other thing. We have discovered unknown friends and well wishers, and have uncovered a score of people who have been reading the Courier for more than a quarter of a century.

We have so many of these letters and personal interviews that it would be impossible to review them all. But their tone is expressed in the few reproduced here.

Mayor E. C. Hackett has been an interested observer and reader during the years of the Courier's life. His letter, printed here, is a valued reminiscence of the old days when Oregon City was growing amid "wild and woolly" trimmings and newspapers were among the trimmings. Mayor Hackett's letter says:

"It is my understanding that the Courier is celebrating its 35th birthday this week and I am glad indeed to congratulate the management thereof."

"I well remember the founder, Mr. T. LeMahieu. He had a lot of ability in many ways and yet a queer fellow in others. He was eccentric, to say the least. In those years, during political campaigns, everything was said and done imaginable, and little or nothing said or done about it afterward."

"I well remember LeMahieu, in speaking of one candidate during an election, said that 'the stole hog.' This 'leaded up to an action in the circuit court, but the matter was dropped. No doubt many of your readers may recall this circumstance. 'Times have changed in this respect in recent years, and we don't see so much 'mud-slinging' any more. None will deny that this is a change for the better, and I believe the Courier is as clean as any average paper. It has had a number of able men at the helm, not the least of whom was M. J. Brown, to say nothing of the present man at the wheel."

"The Oregon City Courier has kept

(Continued on page 8)